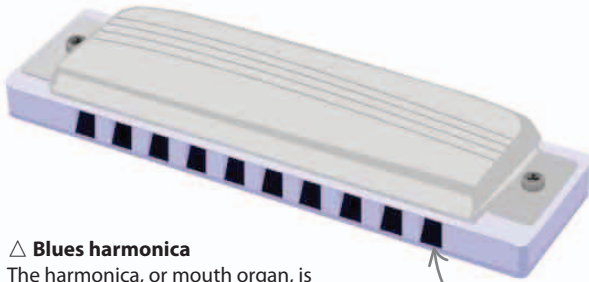


Special sounds

Other instruments, including the harmonica, accordion, extra percussion, saxophones, and even violin, occasionally feature in rock bands. This not only adds variety to the general sound, but can also become a musical “signature”—such as Mick Jagger’s harmonica playing with the Rolling Stones.



△ Blues harmonica

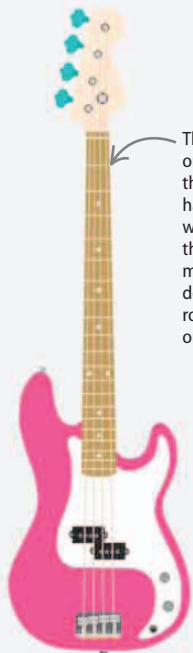
The harmonica, or mouth organ, is particularly popular in blues. It is played by blowing and sucking air through “free” reeds vibrating inside the instrument.

Hole leads to the chamber containing the “free” reed.

REAL WORLD

The Beatles

The most universally recognized of all rock bands, the Beatles were formed in Liverpool, England, in the 1960s. Paul McCartney, John Lennon, George Harrison, and Ringo Starr were accomplished performers, and Lennon and McCartney were gifted songwriters as well. The Beatles’ musical style originated in rock’n’roll, but they later explored a range of other styles, including ballad, experimental, psychedelic rock, and Indian music.



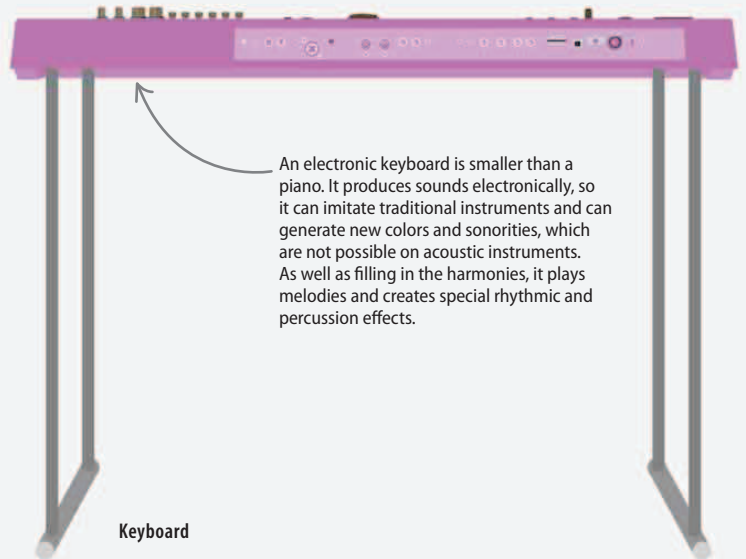
Bass guitar

The bass guitar has four or six strings and plays the lowest notes of the harmony. Its music is written an octave higher than it sounds. The part may be played by a double bass as many rock musicians “double” on both instruments.

Microphones convert sound into an electric signal and direct it to an amplifier.



Vocals



Keyboard

An electronic keyboard is smaller than a piano. It produces sounds electronically, so it can imitate traditional instruments and can generate new colors and sonorities, which are not possible on acoustic instruments. As well as filling in the harmonies, it plays melodies and creates special rhythmic and percussion effects.

**“I won’t be a rock star.
I will be a legend.”**
Freddy Mercury, Queen